

RECOGNITION OF STUDENT AND STAFF ACCOMPLISHMENTS
BY THE SCHOOL BOARD

A. Purpose. The Loudoun County School Board recognizes the importance of acknowledging and celebrating the accomplishments and achievements of students and staff. The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines and procedures for recognizing and honoring outstanding achievements, contributions, and milestones in our educational community.

B. Principles.

1. Equity and Inclusivity. Loudoun County Public Schools is committed to ensuring that recognition opportunities are equitable and inclusive, embracing diversity, and celebrating the accomplishments of all students and staff, regardless of background, abilities, or circumstances.

2. Transparency. The recognition process shall be transparent and well-communicated, allowing students and staff to understand how they can be recognized and how the selection process works.

3. Promote Positive Behaviors. Recognition should encourage positive behaviors, achievements, and contributions that align with the values and goals of the division.

C. Types of Recognition. Honors for consideration should be School Division or educational-based, or directly related to their role as a student or staff member within the division.

1. Student Recognition by the School Board. In an effort to acknowledge students for distinguished accomplishments in state, national, international, and VHSL-sponsored contests, the Loudoun County School Board will recognize teams, ensembles and student publications that earn first-place honors in group competitions.

a. Students will be eligible for School Board recognition if they place first in the following contests:

- (i) VHSL competitions for teams, ensembles and student publications.
- (ii) State competitions for LCPS-recognized clubs.
- (iii) National competitions for LCPS-recognized clubs.
- (iv) International competitions for LCPS-recognized clubs.
- (v) Academic achievements of note at a state, national or international level.

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- (vi) Under unique circumstances, including heroic acts related to a school situation, the School Board may recognize individual students for meritorious achievement beyond the scope of regular academics, activities or job performance.

b. Recognition During Meetings.

- (i) The School Board will recognize students periodically throughout the school year.
- (ii) School Board meeting start times vary depending on the number of items on the agenda, including the number of students being recognized.

c. Submission for Recognition.

- (i) Submissions of names for consideration may come from School Board Members, LCPS employees, parents/guardians or students.
- (ii) Fill out this [Nomination Form](#) to submit a student's name for consideration.
- (iii) Submission is not a guarantee of School Board recognition.

2. Staff Recognition by the School Board. The School Board wishes to recognize staff members for contributions to student achievement, career advancement, service or heroism.

- a. These above-and-beyond contributions to our schools and the broader community may include:
 - (i) Outstanding Performance: Recognizing exceptional contributions to the educational mission of the division.
 - (ii) Professional Development: Honoring staff members who engage in continuous professional development.
 - (iii) Longevity and Service: Recognizing staff members for their years of service to the division.
 - (iv) Innovation and Improvement: Acknowledging staff members who introduce innovative practices or improvements.

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- (v) Heroic Acts: Under unique circumstances, including heroic acts where LCPS training or job functions contributed to the successful outcome the School Board may recognize individuals for meritorious achievement beyond the scope of regular job performance.

b. Recognition During Meetings

- (i) The School Board will recognize staff periodically throughout the school year.
- (ii) School Board meeting agenda length vary depending on the number of items on the agenda, including the number of student and staff recognitions.

c. Submission for Recognition

- (i) Submissions of names for consideration may come from School Board Members, LCPS employees, parents/guardians or students.
- (ii) Fill out this [Nomination Form](#) to submit a staff member's name for consideration.
- (iii) Submission is not a guarantee of School Board recognition.

3. Communication. The division shall communicate the recognition process and criteria to all students and staff members.

- a. Recipients and their families will be informed in a timely and respectful manner well in advance of a scheduled recognition event.
- b. Photos from public meetings (ceremonies) may be distributed to the media or used in LCPS marketing materials, including but not limited to, the website and videos.

4. Awards and Celebrations. School Board recognition may take various forms, including certificates, plaques, ceremonies, or public announcements. School Board recognition does not replace any school special recognition events, such as award ceremonies or assemblies, which may be organized to celebrate student and staff accomplishments.

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5. Review and Updates. This policy shall be reviewed every five years by the School Board and may be amended or updated as necessary to reflect the changing needs and goals of the division.

6. Implementation. The Superintendent and their designees shall be responsible for implementing this policy and ensuring that recognition opportunities are consistently and equitably provided to students and staff in Loudoun County Public Schools.

Adopted: 4/23/24

Revised: 2/22/24

Cross Reference: Policy [2430](#), School Board Agenda